

Agriculture: Potato Pest Management Guidelines

Planting

This year-round IPM program covers the major pests of both commercial and seed potato production fields in California.

About Planting

- [Mitigate pesticide effects\(/agriculture/potato/Pesticide-application-checklist/\)](/agriculture/potato/Pesticide-application-checklist/) on air and water quality.

What should you be doing during this time?

Plant under appropriate [soil temperature and soil moisture conditions\(/agriculture/potato/Seed-Certification-and-Seed-Tuber-Handling/#HANDLING\)](/agriculture/potato/Seed-Certification-and-Seed-Tuber-Handling/#HANDLING) to avoid the following:

- [Bacterial soft rot and blackleg\(/agriculture/potato/Bacterial-Soft-Rot-and-Blackleg/\)](/agriculture/potato/Bacterial-Soft-Rot-and-Blackleg/)
- [Fusarium seed piece decay\(/agriculture/potato/Fusarium-Dry-Rot-and-Seed-Piece-Decay/\)](/agriculture/potato/Fusarium-Dry-Rot-and-Seed-Piece-Decay/)

Based on field history, consider a soil-applied insecticide to control:

- [Aphids\(/agriculture/potato/Aphids/\)](/agriculture/potato/Aphids/)
- [Psyllids\(/agriculture/potato/Potato-Psyllid/\)](/agriculture/potato/Potato-Psyllid/)
- [Flea beetles\(/agriculture/potato/Flea-Beetles/\)](/agriculture/potato/Flea-Beetles/)
- [Wireworms\(/agriculture/potato/Wireworms/\)](/agriculture/potato/Wireworms/)

If possible, select insecticides for in-furrow or seed treatment applications rather than broadcast applications

Consider in-furrow application of nematicide.

Consider applying fungicide in furrows at planting to reduce:

- [Bacterial seed piece decay\(/agriculture/potato/Bacterial-Soft-Rot-and-Blackleg/\)](/agriculture/potato/Bacterial-Soft-Rot-and-Blackleg/)
- [Fusarium seed piece decay\(/agriculture/potato/Fusarium-Dry-Rot-and-Seed-Piece-Decay/\)](/agriculture/potato/Fusarium-Dry-Rot-and-Seed-Piece-Decay/)
- [Stem and stolon canker \(black scurf\)\(/agriculture/potato/Stem-and-Stolon-Canker/\)](/agriculture/potato/Stem-and-Stolon-Canker/)
- [Silver scurf\(/agriculture/potato/Silver-Scurf/\)](/agriculture/potato/Silver-Scurf/)

Consider field edge [plantings of habitat that provides floral resources for natural enemies\(https://anrcatalog.ucanr.edu/pdf/8390.pdf\)](https://anrcatalog.ucanr.edu/pdf/8390.pdf) (PDF) that help control pests in adjacent crops.



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Text Updated: 08/19